Analysis of entertainment media between Q1 2025 and Q1 2026

Is it possible to measure a difference in something as subjective as entertainment using linguistic analysis?

Kean Flanagan



“Entertainment (media) is better in 2026 than 2025."

its been 3 months

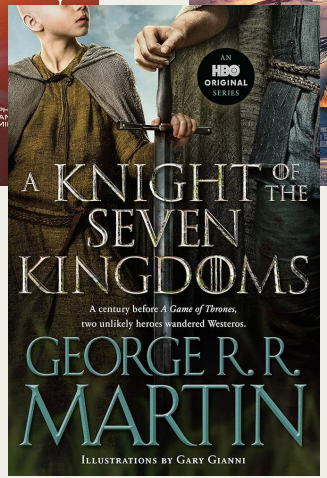


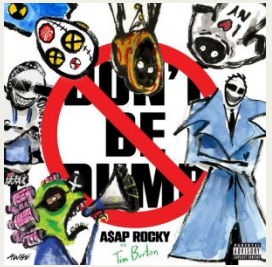












How should I measure this?

Using tokenization and spaCy, along with statistical analysis



Some words to keep in mind

Movie, film, cinema, album, song, meme, viral, trend, artist

Create a Twitter/X corpus

Purpose of my corpus

- for human readability and machine processing

Tweet ID	Period	Year Period	Keyword	Text (raw)
1885105584531226741	2025-Jan	Q1-2025	viral	she went viral, scammed people out of millions, disappeared forever, she's going down in history books.
1885109725710143502	2025-Jan	Q1-2025	viral	BREAKING RINO Utah Senator John Curtis is not too happy with Tulsi Gabbard's performance Here's Curtis's office number: 202-224-5251 Would be a shame if this went Viral on 𝕏 https://t.co/IA9Vb3waAY
1906481816368005405	2025-Mar	Q1-2025	viral	Don't post to go viral Post to become the source code https://t.co/GJ0JPRSThT

What was collected

26395 tweets

using the 9 keywords

January - March 2025
January - March 2026

433K tokens

no urls or mentions

initial tweets provide insight on peoples' initial opinion

+19% engagement from 2025 to 2026

an influx of users?

a baseline number, but could include bot content

keyword	n 2025	n 2026	mean 2025	mean 2026	p-value	verdict
movie	1500	1500	19.6	16.0	0.603	no shift
film	1470	1460	20.9	146.8	0.172	outlier-driven
cinema	1465	1478	102.7	104.7	0.984	no shift
album	1492	1494	29.3	32.4	0.849	no shift
song	1442	1427	15.1	22.7	0.320	no shift
artist	1456	1451	12.0	44.7	**0.0007**	**SIGNIFICANT**
meme	1483	1480	15.7	35.6	**0.072**	**trending**
trend	1456	1460	11.9	27.3	0.097	trending
viral	1478	1403	159.3	30.1	0.3292	no shift ?

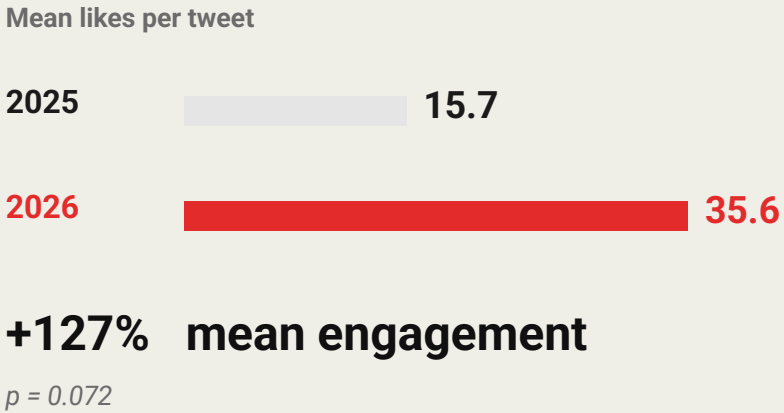
I initially included viral.

It was mostly conflated with world events at the time.

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159.3 avg likes in Q1-2025 compared to 30.1 in Q2-2025

‘Meme’ is especially prominent.



+127% **mean engagement**

p = 0.072

Most tokenized words

Q1 2025		Q1 2026	
coin	*finance leakage*	clip	*short-form content*
market	*crypto / trading talk*	post	*platform-native verb*
price	*macro chatter*	ai	*new top-15 entry*
trump	*political news*	video	*rose into top tokens*
crypto	*common hashtag*	fan	*fandom framing*

What I’ve learned

There is a measurable statistical difference in notable keywords.

There is a vague correlation between the prominence of keywords and media quality.

Q1-2026	meme	-Tired from the long walk- #meme #ELDENRING https://t.co/8XPdfnb3z7
Q1-2026	meme	NEW: Some Ministers are sharing around a meme on WhatsApp comparing Keir Starmer to Principal Skinner from The Simpsons over his approach to the Green Party [@thetimes] https://t.co/NPslGPmES7
Q1-2026	meme	@Charlie_Hebdo_ @elonmusk “The muslims that murdered us are driving a cybertruck in this meme I made about us being murdered by muslims.” https://t.co/zbcK1On7O4
Q1-2026	meme	Spotted at the Verosika Mayday concert-- @fiyah_emb wanted #radioapple as the asajkhfah the coldplay meme! so here you go #appleradio https://t.co/ppqWw69KRD
Q1-2025	meme	@TheNBACentel @SharmsCharania @KDTrey5 FIRST NBA MEME TWEET BACK BANG https://t.co/rzGNE0UrUD
Q1-2025	meme	Now that the SEC has said meme coins are legal I am having an internal debate over dropping #Greed3 https://t.co/ZVVyF1sOUc
Q1-2026	meme	remember when gaon and ode recreated the waking up and clapping meme and turned it into a top coffee ad they’re so goofy I love them sm https://t.co/MhqcesuuxU